CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **August 22, 2026** — a FULL WEEKLY refresh, the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 (two weeks of lighter daily/catch-up touches, including this morning's own Aug 22 catch-up delivery, sit between them). **Today's score set is a DRAFT, awaiting my manual stamp — full weekly refreshes are never auto-stamped regardless of how small the moves are — see the note below.**

◤ **Draft — full weekly refresh, never auto-stamped.** All four qualitative pillars held flat this cycle. Four independent parallel research passes (one per pillar) plus a dedicated fifth adversarial-verification pass re-checked the highest-stakes claims behind this morning's already-delivered numbers — including the cumulative Hormuz-campaign casualty toll that drove Iran War Risk's cut — and nothing found moved a score further in either direction. The adversarial pass initially flagged a possible missed Iran-related incident in the Aug 19-22 window; on review it proved to be the same UAE missile/trade-embargo episode already priced in, just dated a day apart across sources, not a new event. See the Master Report's "My Decision" section for the full rationale.

THE FINAL NUMBER · AUGUST 22, 2026 (DRAFT, FULL WEEKLY REFRESH) · BTC $77,266.84

+0.70 Mild Bull — unchanged from this morning's catch-up delivery; deep re-verification confirms the number, it doesn't move it

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale −10 to +10; horizon-weighted variant +1.22). Positive because the far windows outweigh the near ones — **not a buy-today signal**. It is a "the storm is priced, the recovery isn't" number. All four qualitative pillars held flat this cycle; Bitcoin TA (computed) is effectively unchanged too — BTC ticked up marginally further to $77,266.84 from this morning's $77,169.40, not enough to move the quant pillar's P.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	−1.34	**Mild Bear** — unchanged call band; Iran's cut and TA's rally roughly cancel
3 months	−0.72	**Mild Bear** — the September FOMC still sits inside this window
6 months	+0.40	**Neutral** — CLARITY/Tokenization structural strength vs. Iran's drag
1 year	+2.06	**Bull** — all five pillars still positive
3 years	+3.07	**Strong Bull** — law + adoption + cycle + valuation

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The Mild Bull conclusion stays positive under every leave-one-out drop (+0.33 to +1.12); dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still rounds down to **Neutral**, unchanged from Aug 16. See the Master Report's Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	`CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf`	**The summary.** The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	`CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf`	**The math pillar.** 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	`reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs`	**The story pillars.** CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → Aug 16 committed → Aug 22 draft → Aug 22 draft2, this full weekly refresh).
4	`reports/archive/ + prior-work/`	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	`run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json`	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with run.py blend --set NAME), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal = ((P − 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact** (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (August 22 draft2 P's, pending stamp — full weekly refresh, all four qualitative pillars held flat)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	32	47	58	82	92	Held flat: Sept 15 2:15pm ET cloture vote reconfirmed; Sen. Gallego's on-record Aug 19 remarks confirm the ethics deadlock persists, no White House movement
Iran War Risk	14	22	38	54	76	Held flat: adversarial re-check confirms the campaign casualty toll behind this morning's cut is real (IMO-traceable, though the precise count is a 15-19 range, not a clean number); no new incident found Aug 19-22
Tokenization (RWA)	52	60	66	74	85	Held flat: Franklin Templeton's Aug 12 SEC no-action letter (sec.gov-confirmed) roughly offsets the SEC's canceled tokenized-equity "innovation exemption" meeting; rwa.xyz totals flat
Fed & Macro	43	41	48	56	62	Held flat: FOMC minutes (Aug 19) showed a wider hawkish bloc, but CME FedWatch/Kalshi September-hold odds (~68-70%) were unchanged before and after — already priced
Bitcoin TA (quant)	49	46	54	66	69	Quant pillar recomputed on today's price (BTC $77,266.84, essentially flat vs. this morning's $77,169.40) — weekly composite +26.4 (Slight bullish, 5-of-7), monthly Neutral

P values shown (50 = coin flip). All four qualitative pillars held flat this cycle after four independent, parallel primary-source research passes plus a dedicated adversarial-verification pass found nothing that cleared the sufficiency bar to move a score.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status:** August 22 draft2 — a FULL WEEKLY refresh, the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8, run the same day as (and superseding, per the runbook's same-day-draft rule) this morning's Aug 22 catch-up delivery — is **LEFT AS A DRAFT, flagged for Alex's manual review**, not auto-stamped. This is automatic: the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority never covers full weekly refreshes, regardless of how small the moves are — and this cycle moved nothing at all. Four independent parallel research passes (one per qualitative pillar) plus a dedicated fifth adversarial-verification pass re-checked the five highest-stakes claims behind this morning's numbers, including the Iran War Risk casualty-toll finding — all four pillars held. Every report prints the full lineage (June committed → Aug 16 committed → Aug 22 draft → Aug 22 draft2, still awaiting stamp).
- **Verification:** facts researched with primary/wire-source discipline via four independent, parallel research passes, THEN a dedicated adversarial-verification pass that tried to REFUTE the five highest-stakes claims directly against primary sources (sec.gov, IMO trackers, CME FedWatch, the Senate's own schedule) rather than the pillar research's own citations. Results: the Iran casualty-toll figure held up (though the precise count is a 15-19 range, not a clean number — hedged in-report); the Sept 15 CLARITY cloture date held up; the Franklin Templeton SEC no-action letter was confirmed directly on sec.gov; the ~68-70% CME FedWatch September-hold read held up and a conflicting "93.6% hike" figure was traced to a garbled data conflation and discarded; one initially-flagged "missed incident" (a UAE missile/trade-embargo episode) was reconciled as the same event already priced in, just dated a day apart across sources.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles, a disclosed fragility this report has repeatedly flagged; the TA pillar caps its own conviction at P = 50 ± 25; single-source items are labeled in-line; current chart bars are partial and the completed-bar numbers are printed; the Robustness section shows dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still lands at the Neutral/Mild-Bull boundary, unchanged from Aug 16.
- **The near-term calendar is the test:** next jobless claims and Fed H.4.1, both due Aug 27 · Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair, Aug 28 · the first CLARITY cloture vote, precisely dated 2:15pm ET Sept 15 · an actual signed, operating Hormuz agreement the US accepts, or whether Bessent's promised sanctions package actually lands and how Iran responds · next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot), week of Sept 15 · GENIUS Act 18-month backstop effective Jan 18, 2027. Each pillar's trigger table says in advance what each outcome does to the scores.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check the trigger tables: they are the falsifiable part.